Microsoft's Imagine Cup
The Finalists

The Indian leg of *The Imagine Cup*, Microsoft's annual world-wide, student technology competition is nearing its climax. The competition, which spans multiple categories, featured a local competition for the software design invitational (SDI) category, for which scores of student teams from across the country worked on designing solutions in line with the contest's theme for the year—"*Imagine a world where technology enables a sustainable environment*".

In India, the SDI category started off with teams submitting a synopsis of their solution, with all submitted synopses being evaluated to select the ones with most potential. This led to a pool of around 30 short-listed teams who had to submit detailed presentations and documents (including code-snippets), explaining the core elements of their proposed solutions. This was then followed by a gruelling round of telephonic interviews in late March, with judges from reputed companies in the industry—the focus being not just on evaluating the technical merit, but also on gauging the business-case merits of the solutions.

The teams and solutions that have come out of this searching examination, ready to do battle in the *Imagine Cup National Final in Bangalore on May 9th, 2008*, are as follows. The winning team will represent India in the Imagine Cup World Finals in Paris, in early July.

Team blAnkSpace

Dhirubhai Ambani Institute of Information and Communication Technology, Gandhi Nagar.

▲ Anuj Kumar ▲ Ishan Bishnoi
▲ Prateek Khurana ▲ Ravi Atluri

A system to connect those who want to dispose of "garbage / junk" with those who might have innovative uses for the same. The system also gives potential users of such items optimal collection-paths to collect all the items in a locality.

Team Eco Warriors

Vivekananda Educational Society's Institute of Technology, Mumbai

▲ Apurva Arvindakshan Nair ▲ Charu Rajkumar Jain
▲ Ishita Sunity Chakraborty ▲ Mamal Jayendra Karani

An ecological e-Governance mechanism that gathers information from different service-providers about usage by citizens, and then calculates corresponding carbon-emission-levels. Ecological-performance reports are also generated for individuals, based on which they can be taxed.

Team EcoPals

National Institute of Technology, Kurukshetra

▼ Arpita Shrivastava ▼ Kshitij Shukla
▼ Rohit Bhat ▼ U. Karthik

An interactive application to dynamically guide farmers as to which crops are best suited to their soil, water and weather conditions, which fertilizers, irrigation schemes, and other agricultural methods to use. The application also assesses the effect of the current crop on the soil condition and suggests the crop that should be sown next, which it then iteratively uses to suggest a series of crops to grow one after the other.

Team GRAS

BITS Pilani, Goa Campus

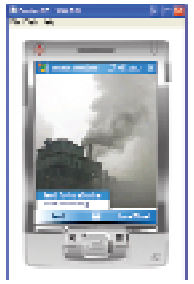
▼ Abhishek Kumar
▼ Gaurav Paruthi
▼ Shubham Malhotra

A mobile-phone-based application that uses Web services to share real-time data with potential buyers of products at the point-of-purchase. The data contains information on the carbon-footprint of each product and aims to educate potential buyers into making smart and ecologically empathetic choices.

Team Green Waves

Delhi University

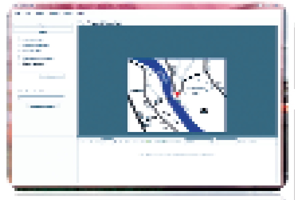
▼ Aadhar Mittal ▼ Gagandeep Singh
▼ Sandeep Bansal ▼ Shobhit Sinha



A citizen-activism-based solution that exhorts the public to take photographs of environmental issues in their daily life, and to send the same via mobile phone to a centralised agency, which can then disseminate the information to appropriate NGOs.

Team Gurus

Chennai Mathematical Institute
Dhirubhai Ambani Institute of Information and Communication Technology, Gandhi Nagar

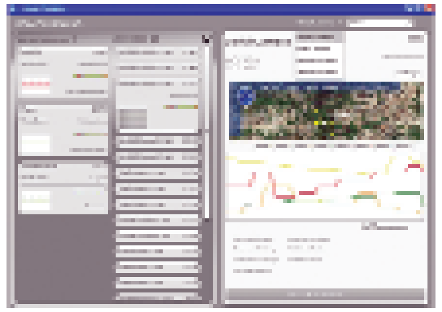


▲ Abhishek Chhajer ▲ Archit Jain
▲ Sasank Tatineni ▲ Amit Prakash Ambastha

A system that accepts inputs from the public on the preferred locations for civic utilities and resources such as sewers and dust-bins. The system then uses Vertex Cover algorithms and K-Means algorithms to determine the most suitable location for the same, thereby offering an ideal blend of democratic participation and scientific rationale in town-planning.

Team Novices@Work

Vivekananda Educational Society's Institute of Technology, Mumbai

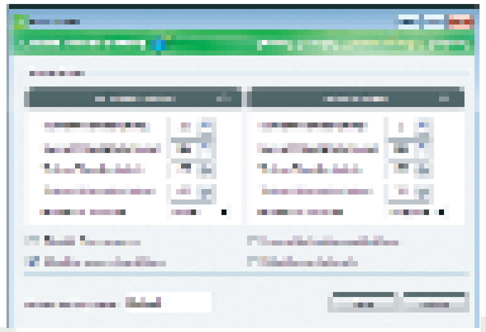


▲ Krunal Dedhia ▲ Paras Doshi ▲ Saili Dharia ▲ Veenit Mavani

A self-configurable wireless-sensor mesh-network system that monitors and analyses agricultural-soil parameters such as moisture-content, nutrient composition, temperature, pressure and light. This system can be used by the government or NGOs at a large scale in order to provide recommendations to farmers on crop-related decisions.

Team SKAN

Bharti Vidyapeeth College of Engineering, Mumbai
Fr. Conceicao Rodrigues Institute of Technology, Mumbai
Vivekananda Educational Society's Institute of Technology, Mumbai



▲ Amith P George ▲ Karun A. B. ▲ Noel Sequeira
▲ Sameet Singh Khajuria

A centralised power-management system to monitor an organisation's entire computer network and to switch idle computers into the power-save mode.

For more details about The Imagine Cup, as well as to participate in the Digital Photography category, please see the official Imagine Cup Web site at www.imaginecup.com.